



DIRECTORATE OF RESEARCH, INNOVATION, COMMERCIALIZATION AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP (DRICE)

THE 2025/2026 OPEN CALL FOR PROPOSALS DAYSTAR UNIVERSITY INTERNAL RESEARCH GRANT

Daystar University, through the Directorate of Research, Innovation, Commercialization and Entrepreneurship (DRICE), invites eligible members of staff to submit proposals for the **2025/2026 Daystar University Internal Research Grant**.

This internal grant is intended to strengthen Daystar University's research culture by supporting high-quality, innovative, interdisciplinary, and impact-oriented research aligned to the University's mission, strategic priorities, and commitment to scholarship, innovation, community transformation, and national development

Purpose of the Daystar University Internal Research Grant

The Daystar University Internal Research Grant seeks to:

- promote a strong and sustainable institutional research culture;
- support competitive, interdisciplinary, and innovative research;
- strengthen mentorship of early-career academics and postgraduate students;
- enhance research productivity, scholarly visibility, and publication output;
- generate research with academic, policy, community, and commercialization value;
- contribute to Daystar University's strategic agenda in research, innovation, and societal impact.

Thematic Areas

Proposals should demonstrate clear relevance to Daystar University's academic and societal mission and align with national and global development priorities, including but not limited to

- Education, Leadership, and Public Policy
- Health, Mental Health, and Community Wellbeing
- Theology, Ethics, and Values-Based Development
- Media, Communication, and Digital Transformation
- Business, Entrepreneurship, and Economic Development
- Governance, Peace, Justice, and Social Development
- Climate Change, Environment, and Sustainability
- Science, Technology, Innovation, and Artificial Intelligence
- Cross-cutting and interdisciplinary issues

Financial Allocation

The maximum amount that may be awarded under this call is **KSh 800,000 per project**.

Applicants are expected to propose realistic, well-justified budgets aligned to the scope of work and planned deliverables.

Project Duration

The maximum duration of the project shall be **twelve (12) months** from the date of signing the grant agreement.

Eligibility Criteria

Applicants must meet the following conditions:

- The Principal Investigator (PI) must be a **full-time member of staff of Daystar University**.
- The PI should ordinarily be at the rank of **Lecturer or above**, with demonstrated capacity to lead research.
- Proposals should, as far as possible, be **interdisciplinary** in nature.
- Research teams are encouraged to include **junior researchers**, including early-career academics and postgraduate students, for mentorship and research capacity development.
- The proposal must clearly state the expertise, role, and contribution of each team member.
- **Principal Investigators and research teams currently holding, implementing, or benefiting from any active Daystar Internal Grant shall NOT be eligible to apply for this call until they have fully completed all current grant obligations, including approved deliverables, technical reports, financial accountability requirements, and formal grant closure processes.**
- Incomplete applications and applications submitted after the deadline shall not be considered.

Components of the Proposal

Applicants shall submit proposals using the official Daystar University grant application templates.

The proposal should clearly include:

- Title of the project
- Background and justification
- Problem statement
- Objectives of the study
- Methodology
- Expected outputs and outcomes
- Relevance to scholarship, policy, community transformation, innovation, and/or commercialization
- Work plan or implementation schedule
- Detailed budget and budget justification
- Team composition, expertise, and roles

Additional requirements:

- The technical proposal should **not exceed 10 pages**, excluding appendices.
- Each collaborator should provide a brief résumé/CV.
- Proposals should indicate how junior researchers and/or postgraduate students will be mentored, where applicable.
- Involvement of relevant stakeholders and communities, where appropriate, will be considered an added advantage.
- The grant will support approved research activities only and shall not cover tuition, personal stipends, or unrelated costs.

Additional requirements:

- The technical proposal should **not exceed 10 pages**, excluding annexes.
- A **detailed budget** must be attached.
- A **curriculum vitae** of the Principal Investigator and key team members should be included.
- Evidence of relevant approvals, where applicable, shall be required before project commencement.

Selection Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated competitively based on the following criteria:

- relevance to Daystar University's strategic research and innovation agenda;
- clarity and significance of the problem being addressed;
- methodological rigor and feasibility;

- originality, innovation, and interdisciplinarity;
- potential for scholarly output, policy influence, community impact, and/or commercialization;
- mentorship of junior researchers and postgraduate students;
- value for money and appropriateness of the budget;
- likelihood of successful completion within the grant period.

Conditions of Award

Successful applicants will be expected to:

- participate in an inception meeting organized by DRICE;
- implement the project within the approved period and budget;
- submit **quarterly technical and financial progress reports**;
- comply fully with Daystar University's research ethics, financial accountability, innovation, and intellectual property requirements;
- present their findings at an approved Daystar University research dissemination forum or conference;
- generate publishable outputs, policy-relevant outputs, innovation outputs, or other approved scholarly products arising from the funded work;
- acknowledge Daystar University Internal Research Grant support in all resulting publications, presentations, reports, innovations, and related outputs.

Selection Criteria

- Submitted proposals will be evaluated competitively based on:
- alignment with Daystar University's research and innovation priorities;
- clarity and significance of the problem being addressed;
- methodological rigor and feasibility;
- interdisciplinarity and innovativeness;
- potential for scholarly, institutional, policy, community, or commercialization impact;
- mentorship value for junior researchers and postgraduate students;
- appropriateness and realism of the proposed budget;
- likelihood of successful completion within the grant period

Submission Procedure

Completed proposals should be submitted electronically via.....Click on click below:

All submissions should be clearly marked. **“Application for the 2025/2026 Daystar University Internal Research Grant”**

Deadline for Submission

The deadline for submission of proposals is 20th May 2026.

Late submissions shall not be accepted.

Further Information

For further clarification, applicants may contact:

The Director, DRICE

Daystar University

Email: drice@daystar.ac.ke